OPEN LETTER · EYE ON SHOALHAVEN COUNCIL

Stephen Prothero asks Shoalhaven Council to clarify Sanctuary Point Library funding plan

Sent 7 July 2026 · To Mayor White, Andrew Constance, Cr Tribe, Cr Norris, Cr Boyd, Cr Krikstolaitis, Cr Killian, Cr Proudfoot, Cr Casmiri, Cr Dunn, Cr Wilkins · Response requested by 28 July 2026

Dear Mr Constance and Mayor White,

I am writing to seek clarification on Council's current position in relation to Commonwealth funding and the forward plan for the Sanctuary Point Library.

Could you please confirm whether Council is now seeking only a little over $2 million from the Commonwealth for planning and related preparatory work, rather than pursuing the previously announced $7.5 million funding commitment for the library project itself?

Could you also confirm whether Council has contacted the relevant Commonwealth Department directly about the status of the $7.5 million funding, including whether that funding remains available, whether it can be varied, and what steps Council would need to take to preserve or re-scope it?

In addition, could you please clarify what engagement Council has had with the Federal Member for Gilmore in relation to this matter. Has Council actually met with or spoken directly to the Member for Gilmore, or has the engagement been limited to correspondence by letter or email?

If Council has only written or emailed, could you please explain why Council has not sought a direct meeting with the Federal Member, given the importance of this project to the Sanctuary Point community and the need to resolve the Commonwealth funding position as soon as possible?

More broadly, could Council please explain what the actual current plan is for the Sanctuary Point Library. In particular:

- **What funding is Council now seeking?**
- **What project is Council now proposing to deliver?**
- **What is the current estimated cost?**
- **What site is Council proceeding with?**
- **What is the expected timetable?**
- **What risks are there to the existing or proposed Commonwealth funding?**
- **What steps are being taken to avoid the community losing the benefit of funding that was previously announced for this library?**

This issue has now become difficult for the community to follow. Residents were previously told that substantial Commonwealth funding had been secured for the library,

yet it now appears Council may be seeking a much smaller amount and may not have fully pursued direct engagement with either the Department or the local Federal Member.

Given the long history of this project, I would appreciate a clear public explanation of Council's current position, the funding pathway, and the practical steps being taken to deliver the library.

Yours sincerely,

Stephen Prothero
